

NAME

`remove_stale_templates.py` – quarantine stale manual saved templates and prune their schedlist lines

SYNOPSIS

```
remove_stale_templates.py --data-dir DIR --quarantine-dir DIR --logs-report-dir DIR
--logs-hist-dir DIR [--index-cache-path PATH] [--years N] [--exclude-owner OWNER ...] [--ex-
clude-owner-regex PATTERN ...] [--execute | --restore RUN_DIR]
```

DESCRIPTION

remove_stale_templates.py finds *stale saved templates* in a Symphony ILS report-scheduler data directory (*rptsched*) and moves their files into quarantine, removing the corresponding line from *schedlist*.

Candidate selection does **not** use *schedlist*'s own **last_run/created** fields as an activity signal – empirical testing found those fields never update for the most common real usage pattern (ad hoc "Run Now" on a manual template), which caused a real production incident. Instead, activity is looked up in two independent log sources outside *rptsched*: *Logs/Report/* (unconditional "**Finished report**" lines, no owner) and *Logs/Hist/* (owner-attributed, decoded via Symphony's own **logprint** | **translate** pipeline, and the only source that sees ad hoc runs at all). See *2026-08-31-remove-stale-templates-log-based-redesign.md* for the full design and empirical basis.

A saved template (one row of *schedlist*, plus its *<id>.set* / *<id>.selans* file group) is a stale-template candidate when **all** of the following hold:

- **frequency_flag** is **n** – the template is manual (run by hand only), not on a recurring Symphony schedule.
- **owner** is not excluded by any **--exclude-owner** or **--exclude-owner-regex** entry passed on the command line.
- Its (**report_source**, **description**) pair shows no activity in *Logs/Report/* within **--years**, and its (**report_source**, **description**, **owner**) triple shows no activity in *Logs/Hist/* within **--years** either. A match in *either* source protects the template – this is deliberate defense in depth given the category's history.
- **created** is at least **--years** years before today – a template that's simply new is protected even with no log activity yet, since **created** (unlike **last_run**) stays a trustworthy one-time stamp for manual templates specifically.

Unlike orphans, every stale-template candidate has a live *schedlist* line. This tool removes that line – via write-temp-file plus atomic rename, never an in-place edit – so nothing is left dangling. Restoring a run re-inserts the exact removed lines back into the *current* schedlist.

OPTIONS

--data-dir DIR

Path to the *rptsched* data directory to scan and modify. Required in every mode, including **--restore**.

--quarantine-dir DIR

Path to the quarantine directory that holds run subfolders. Created if it does not already exist. Required in every mode.

--logs-report-dir DIR

Path to Symphony's *Logs/Report/* directory. Required for dry-run and **--execute**; not needed for **--restore**, which replays a past run's exact removed lines rather than re-evaluating activity.

--logs-hist-dir DIR

Path to Symphony's *Logs/Hist/* directory. Same required-ness as **--logs-report-dir**. Decoding this source shells out to **logprint** and **translate**, which only exist on the production server.

--index-cache-path *PATH*

Where to persist the activity-index cache between runs, so unchanged *Logs/Hist/* months (the expensive source to decode) aren't reprocessed every invocation. Defaults to a file under **--quarantine-dir**. Only used by **--execute** – dry-run never writes anything, including this cache.

--years *N*

Inactivity threshold in years, applied to both the log-activity lookup and, as a floor protecting new templates, **created**. Default: **3**.

--exclude-owner *OWNER*

Exclude templates whose **owner** is an exact, case-insensitive match for *OWNER*. Repeatable – pass once per owner to exclude a specific set. No substring matching: **--exclude-owner ACQ1** excludes only an owner literally named **ACQ1**, not **ACQ10**. Not set by default – this script excludes no owners unless told to.

--exclude-owner-regex *PATTERN*

Exclude templates whose **owner** matches regex *PATTERN* via case-insensitive, unanchored **re.search**. Repeatable. Breadth is the caller's responsibility through regex syntax – e.g. **ACQ** matches **ACQ1**, **ACQHQ**, and **jsmith-acq** anywhere in the owner string; **^ACQ** matches only owners starting with it. Not set by default.

--execute

Perform the move and the *schedlist* rewrite. Without this flag the script runs in dry-run mode and writes nothing.

--restore *RUN_DIR*

Reverse a previous **--execute** run: restore quarantined files, then re-insert their removed *schedlist* lines. Mutually exclusive with **--execute**.

MODES**Dry run (default)**

Prints the count of stale-template candidates, the total count of manual templates in *schedlist* (regardless of staleness or owner exclusion), and total files, then one line per candidate: id, description, report_source, owner, frequency_flag, created, and its file list. **last_run** is deliberately not shown – it plays no part in the decision and displaying it invites the exact misreading that caused the original production incident. Nothing on disk is touched, including the activity-index cache.

Execute

With **--execute**, the script:

1. Finds candidates as described above. If none are found, prints a message and exits 0 without creating a run subfolder.
2. Creates **--quarantine-dir/templates_TIMESTAMP** and moves each candidate's file group into it, writing *manifest.csv* (same mechanics and partial-failure behavior as **remove_orphans.py(1)**).
3. Writes the exact removed *schedlist* lines, verbatim and in id order, to *removed_schedlist_lines.txt* in the run subfolder.
4. Rewrites *schedlist* to drop those lines, via a temp file plus atomic rename.

Steps 3 and 4 only run after every file in step 2 has been moved successfully; a move failure aborts before *schedlist* is touched, so a failed run never produces a dangling *schedlist* line.

Restore

With **--restore** *RUN_DIR*, the script:

1. Restores quarantined files exactly as **remove_orphans.py(1)**'s **--restore** does: idempotent, resumable, skips rows whose *dest_path* no longer exists, aborts on a *source_path* collision.

2. Reads *RUN_DIR/removed_schedlist_lines.txt* (if present – an empty result is treated as "no lines to reinsert", not an error) and re-inserts each line into the **current** schedlist at the position matching its **created** timestamp, without disturbing the relative order of any line that wasn't touched. *schedlist*'s real on-disk order is chronological by **created**, not alphabetical by id.

The re-insert step is idempotent independently of the file-restore step: it skips any line whose id is already present in the current schedlist, so it is safe even if the current schedlist has legitimate edits made after the original removal run, and safe to re-run.

EXIT STATUS

- 0** Success – including a clean dry run, an execute run that found zero candidates, or a restore that skipped everything because it was already complete.
- 1** A move, schedlist rewrite, or restore operation failed; or **--logs-report-dir/--logs-hist-dir** contains zero files within **--years** (refused rather than silently treating every manual template as inactive – likely a wrong or unmounted path). Details are printed to stderr.

FILES

<data-dir>/schedlist

Read to find candidates; rewritten in place (atomically) by **--execute** to drop matched lines, and again by **--restore** to re-insert them.

<quarantine-dir>/templates_<timestamp>/manifest.csv

File-move record, same format as **remove_orphans.py**(1).

<quarantine-dir>/templates_<timestamp>/removed_schedlist_lines.txt

The exact *schedlist* lines removed by this run, one per line, verbatim. Never deleted – required for **--restore** and doubles as an audit record.

EXAMPLES

Preview stale templates using the default 3-year threshold:

```
remove_stale_templates.py --data-dir ./rptsched --quarantine-dir ./quarantine --logs-report-dir /software/WYLD/Unicorn/Logs/Report --logs-hist-dir /software/WYLD/Unicorn/Logs/Hist
```

Use a 5-year threshold instead:

```
remove_stale_templates.py --data-dir ./rptsched --quarantine-dir ./quarantine --logs-report-dir /software/WYLD/Unicorn/Logs/Report --logs-hist-dir /software/WYLD/Unicorn/Logs/Hist --years 5
```

Execute a run:

```
remove_stale_templates.py --data-dir ./rptsched --quarantine-dir ./quarantine --logs-report-dir /software/WYLD/Unicorn/Logs/Report --logs-hist-dir /software/WYLD/Unicorn/Logs/Hist --execute
```

Exclude a specific list of owners:

```
remove_stale_templates.py --data-dir ./rptsched --quarantine-dir ./quarantine --logs-report-dir /software/WYLD/Unicorn/Logs/Report --logs-hist-dir /software/WYLD/Unicorn/Logs/Hist --exclude-owner ACQ1 --exclude-owner ACQ2
```

Exclude any owner containing "ACQ", regardless of case:

```
remove_stale_templates.py --data-dir ./rptsched --quarantine-dir ./quarantine --logs-report-dir /software/WYLD/Unicorn/Logs/Report --logs-hist-dir /software/WYLD/Unicorn/Logs/Hist --exclude-owner-regex ACQ
```

Undo a specific run (files and schedlist lines both, no log dirs needed):

```
remove_stale_templates.py --data-dir ./rptsched --quarantine-dir ./quarantine --restore ./quarantine/templates_20260826_140501
```

SEE ALSO

remove_orphans.py(1), **sync_operator_field.py(1)**

Domain reference: *rptsched-domain-reference.md* in the *rptsched-cleanup* repository – see "Inactivity rule" and "Owner exclusion" under "Definitions", and the *shedlist* field table.

CAVEATS

Requires Python 3.6.8, standard library only.

The **--years** value must match between the run that removed a template and any later reasoning about it; re-store replays the exact removed line rather than re-evaluating staleness, so it is unaffected by a later change to **--years**.

This tool only ever considers manual templates (**frequency_flag** == "n"). Recurring-schedule templates are the separate, not-yet-built "scheduled report removal candidates" category described in the project's *CLAUDE.md*.